

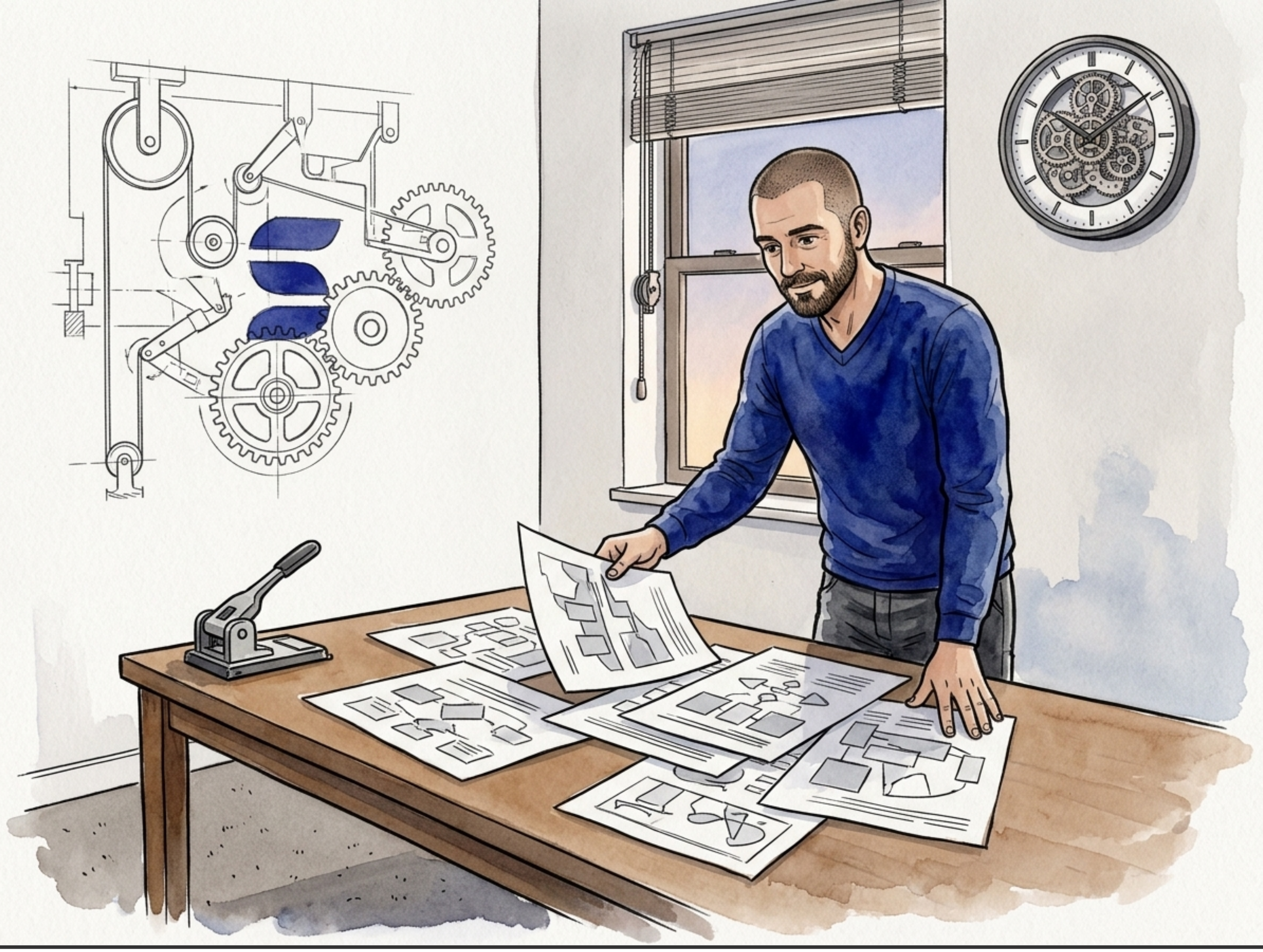
You asked the expert. You got charts.

Now you are the one who has to work out what they mean.



The work you delegated came back.

You asked them because they know the numbers. A pile of charts hands the figuring-out back to you.



I had to become the expert.

A team member sent year-end charts with no sentences. Before I could pass anything up, I had to learn their work.



Order matters more than length.

I will stop reading when I have what I need. Put what I need first.



1. Start with where things stand.

Say the status first: hours per defect moved from 42 to 37 over the last year. (Made-up numbers, for the example.)



2. Then your read, then the ask.

Say what it means to you and what you need. Put the detail underneath for anyone who wants to check it.



Would your reader know what you think?

If they only read the subject line and the first three sentences, what would they take away?